

You will prepare an Unessay project on a topic of your choice that is related to sociology. The instructor must be notified of your topic and project medium before you begin preparing your Unessay. Once you have identified a potential topic, plan how you will present the information that you will gather about it over the course of the semester.

Ummm...What's an Unessay???

An “Unessay” is the radical younger sibling of the traditional term paper. While I did not invent it, it’s being used by professors all over the country and the results are pretty incredible! Some of the possibilities for the project include (but are not limited to) creating a music video, creating an art piece that reflects your understanding of the topic, writing a screenplay, creating a board/role playing game, making a series of BuzzFeed style listicles (e.g. “Which subculture best describes your personality?”...clickbaity stuff), designing a lesson plan about the topic for K-12 instruction, making a comic strip, making a podcast, etc.¹

Assignment Submission Requirements

All projects, regardless of medium, must be accompanied by a short (1-2 double-spaced pages) written statement (the synopsis) describing why you chose the topic, why you chose to present it in the way you did, and how you went about the process of producing the Unessay. The project synopsis will be uploaded to D2L by the due date. If you choose to do a Unessay that is not readily convertible to electronic format, you will turn it in class on the day it is due. If your Unessay is readily convertible to electronic format, you will submit it in the same document as your project synopsis (e.g. if you chose to do a music video, you would upload it to YouTube as an unlisted video and then provide a link to it at the end of your synopsis document).

Graded Elements:

- Clarity of the synopsis [25%]
- How much attention and effort are evident in the production of the Unessay [30%]
- How effective and compelling your Unessay is [45%]
 - An effective Unessay is easily readable/watchable/viewable/listenable and is attractively presented (e.g. a PowerPoint will likely not fulfill this requirement sufficiently).
 - An Unessay is compelling if it is complete (does not leave out important information), interesting, and any questions, evidence, conclusions, or arguments you raise are honestly and accurately presented.
 - Fulfilling these criteria is easier if you pick a subject that interests you.

¹ More general information about UnEssays: <https://marckissel.netlify.app/post/on-the-unessay/>, <http://s17tot.rvancordell.org/assignments/unessays/>, <https://esclark.hcommons.org/the-unessay/>